

D753

Behavioral Intervention Strategies and Applied Behavior Analysis

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A fifth grader with ADHD often calls out in class. The teacher, who is in her third year, has started removing one homework problem each time the student raises his hand quietly. Hand raising increases over two weeks. The class sits in pods of four. What is this procedure?

- A. Negative punishment
- B. Negative reinforcement
- C. Positive reinforcement
- D. Positive punishment

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to use negative punishment to reduce a student's throwing of materials. Which action fits?

- A. Remove five minutes of preferred computer time after each throw.
- B. Add a verbal reprimand after each throw.
- C. Remove a disliked task after the student stops throwing.
- D. Give praise when materials stay on the desk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A student's FBA showed he whines to get adult attention. Staff now ignore whining and praise polite requests. On days 2 and 3, whining gets louder and longer. The student's grandmother just moved in with the family, and the school installed new lights. What should the team do?

- A. Give attention to whining only when it is very loud.
- B. Blame the grandmother's move for the change.
- C. Stay consistent; this is likely an extinction burst, and keep praising polite requests.
- D. Stop the plan because the behavior is getting worse.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

During an extinction plan, one aide sometimes gives in and responds to the student's whining. What is the most likely result?

- A.** The student learns a new replacement behavior.
- B.** No effect, since most staff are consistent.
- C.** The whining becomes more persistent and harder to reduce.
- D.** The whining stops faster.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A second grader gets out of her seat to seek attention. The teacher plans to give a sticker each time the student raises her hand to ask for help while seated. The student loves unicorns, and the class uses flexible seating on Fridays. Which procedure is this?

- A.** DRO
- B.** DRL
- C.** Extinction
- D.** DRA

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to reinforce a behavior that physically cannot occur while a student is hand-flapping. Which plan fits?

- A.** Reinforce every five minutes without flapping.
- B.** Reinforce holding a fidget object with both hands.
- C.** Reinforce saying 'I need a break.'
- D.** Reinforce fewer than three flaps per hour.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A team writes, "Jordan is disrespectful." Jordan has a new baby sister and is on the soccer team. Which revision is an operational definition?

- A.** "Says 'no' or walks away within 10 seconds of an adult direction."
- B.** "Is jealous of the new baby."
- C.** "Is always defiant."
- D.** "Has a bad attitude toward adults."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An FBA for a seventh grader finds that during independent writing tasks, he tears his paper and is sent to the hallway. His older cousin was recently suspended, and he likes basketball. Which hypothesis statement is best?

- A. "During independent writing, he tears his paper in order to escape the task."
- B. "He tears paper because he has an emotional disability."
- C. "He tears paper during writing."
- D. "He tears paper to get peer attention like his cousin."

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hypothesis states: "When given a math worksheet, Ana puts her head down to avoid the work." Which intervention fits this function?

- A. Send her to the hallway when she puts her head down.
- B. Give her more adult attention when her head is down.
- C. Add ten more problems each time.
- D. Teach her to ask for a short break or help and adjust task difficulty, while not removing the task for head-down.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A student with a behavior plan loves building with blocks but avoids spelling practice. The class schedule was changed last month, and the class has a student teacher. How should the teacher use the Premack principle?

- A. "Build with blocks first to get ready, then spell."
- B. "No blocks for the rest of the year."
- C. "First finish your spelling list, then you may build with blocks."
- D. "Build with blocks while the student teacher does spelling with you."

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

A teacher completes a behavior screener. One student, a strong reader who sits by the window, has stopped talking to peers, eats lunch alone, and says she feels 'nothing matters.' She never disrupts class. How should she be rated?

- A.** As fine, since she is a strong reader.
- B.** As showing internalizing concerns that warrant follow-up.
- C.** As no concern, because she never disrupts class.
- D.** As externalizing, since she withdrew from peers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A fourth grader has had five minor office referrals this quarter for talking back, even though the school's Tier 1 expectations are taught well. He is new to the district and plays the trumpet. Which support fits next?

- A.** Reteach schoolwide rules to the whole school.
- B.** Assign him to band as a reward.
- C.** A full FBA and individualized BIP right away.
- D.** Check-in/check-out with a mentor, a daily point card, and a home report.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A fifth grader with ADHD often calls out in class. The teacher, ~~who is in her third year~~, has started removing one homework problem each time the student raises his hand quietly. Hand raising increases over two weeks. ~~The class sits in pods of four~~. What is this procedure?

Target word: classify the procedure **Decides:** Something removed; behavior increased.

A	Confusion set	Punishment decreases behavior; hand raising increased.
B	Correct	Removing homework (negative) increased hand raising (reinforcement).
C	Inverted operation	Nothing was added; homework was removed.
D	Adjacent category	Both the operation and the effect are wrong.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher wants to use negative punishment to reduce a student's throwing of materials. Which action fits?

Target word: reverse: from label to action **Decides:** Remove something pleasant to decrease behavior.

A	Correct	Taking away something pleasant to reduce behavior.
B	Confusion set	Adding something is positive punishment.
C	Inverted operation	That is negative reinforcement of stopping.
D	Adjacent category	Positive reinforcement of an alternative.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A student's FBA showed he whines to get adult attention. Staff now ignore whining and praise polite requests. On days 2 and 3, whining gets louder and longer. ~~The student's grandmother just moved in with the family, and the school installed new lights~~. What should the team do?

Target word: interpret a spike **Decides:** Reinforcement was withheld and behavior spiked.

A	Absolute language	Reinforces the most intense version of the behavior.
B	Camouflage	Timing points to the new plan.
C	Correct	Bursts are expected before behavior drops.
D	Inverted operation	Giving attention now teaches louder whining works.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

During an extinction plan, one aide sometimes gives in and responds to the student's whining. What is the most likely result?

Target word: reverse: effect of inconsistency **Decides:** Intermittent reinforcement.

A	Confusion set	Nothing new is being taught by giving in.
B	Dropped element	Drops the impact of intermittent reinforcement.
C	Correct	Occasional reinforcement makes behavior resist extinction.
D	Inverted operation	Reinforcement keeps behavior going.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A second grader gets out of her seat to seek attention. The teacher plans to give a sticker each time the student raises her hand to ask for help while seated. ~~The student loves unicorns, and the class uses flexible seating on Fridays.~~ Which procedure is this?

Target word: identify differential reinforcement type **Decides:** A specific alternative behavior is reinforced.

A	Confusion set	DRO reinforces absence of the behavior over time.
B	Adjacent category	DRL reinforces lower rates, not a new behavior.
C	Dropped element	Drops the reinforcement of a new behavior.
D	Correct	Reinforces a specific alternative way to get attention.

6. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

A teacher wants to reinforce a behavior that physically cannot occur while a student is hand-flapping. Which plan fits?

Target word: reverse: pick the DRI plan **Decides:** Incompatible behavior.

A	Confusion set	That is DRO.
B	Correct	Both hands occupied is incompatible with flapping (DRI).
C	Inverted operation	That is DRA; speaking can occur while flapping.
D	Adjacent category	That is DRL.

7. Answer A Concept 4

A team writes, "Jordan is disrespectful." ~~Jordan has a new baby sister and is on the soccer team.~~ Which revision is an operational definition?

Target word: operational definition **Decides:** Observable, measurable actions.

A	Correct	Observable, countable, and clear to two observers.
B	Camouflage	A guess about emotion using the home detail.
C	Absolute language	Label plus absolute.
D	Adjacent category	Still a label.

8. Answer A Concept 5

An FBA for a seventh grader finds that during independent writing tasks, he tears his paper and is sent to the hallway. ~~His older cousin was recently suspended, and he likes basketball.~~ Which hypothesis statement is best?

Target word: write the hypothesis **Decides:** Antecedent, behavior, and function (escape).

A	Correct	Names antecedent, behavior, and maintaining consequence.
B	Adjacent category	A diagnosis is not a function.
C	Dropped element	Drops the function.
D	Camouflage	Uses the cousin detail; the data show escape.

9. Answer D Concept 5 · transfer

A hypothesis states: “When given a math worksheet, Ana puts her head down to avoid the work.” Which intervention fits this function?

Target word: reverse: from hypothesis to plan **Decides:** Escape-maintained behavior.

A	Inverted operation	Removing the task reinforces avoidance.
B	Confusion set	Attention is not the function.
C	Absolute language	Punishing with more work can escalate escape.
D	Correct	Gives an acceptable escape route and reduces aversiveness.

10. Answer C Concept 6

A student with a behavior plan loves building with blocks but avoids spelling practice. ~~The class schedule was changed last month, and the class has a student teacher.~~ How should the teacher use the Premack principle?

Target word: apply Premack **Decides:** Low-probability first, then high-probability.

A	Inverted operation	Preferred activity first removes the contingency.
B	Absolute language	Removes the reinforcer entirely.
C	Correct	Access to the preferred activity depends on the task.
D	Camouflage	Uses the student teacher; blends tasks without a contingency.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A teacher completes a behavior screener. One student, ~~a strong reader who sits by the window,~~ has stopped talking to peers, eats lunch alone, and says she feels ‘nothing matters.’ She never disrupts class. How should she be rated?

Target word: recognize internalizing concerns **Decides:** Withdrawal and hopelessness are internalizing signs.

A	Camouflage	Academic strength does not rule out emotional needs.
B	Correct	Inward-directed signs matter even without disruption.
C	Inverted operation	Confuses absence of externalizing with no need.
D	Confusion set	Withdrawal is internalizing.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A fourth grader has had five minor office referrals this quarter for talking back, even though the school’s Tier 1 expectations are taught well. ~~He is new to the district and plays the trumpet.~~ Which support fits next?

Target word: choose tier and intervention **Decides:** Repeated minor issues despite solid Tier 1.

A	Confusion set	Tier 1 is already in place and working for most.
B	Camouflage	Uses the trumpet detail; not an intervention tier.
C	Adjacent category	That is Tier 3, for more intense or unresponsive needs.
D	Correct	CICO is the standard Tier 2 match.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Reinforcement vs. punishment, positive vs. negative	Reinforcement increases a behavior and punishment decreases it; positive means something is added and negative means something is removed.	Thinking negative reinforcement means punishment, or that 'positive' means pleasant.	What happens after the behavior and whether the behavior goes up or down.
2	Extinction burst	When reinforcement for a behavior stops, the behavior usually gets worse for a while before it drops, so staff must stay consistent.	Deciding the plan failed when the behavior briefly increases.	A behavior spikes right after the adults stop reinforcing it.
3	Differential reinforcement types	DRA reinforces a specific alternative behavior; DRI reinforces a behavior that cannot happen at the same time; DRO reinforces the absence of the behavior for an interval; DRL reinforces lower rates.	Mixing up DRA and DRI, or using DRO when a replacement skill must be taught.	A plan names what is reinforced and when.
4	Operational definitions	Define behavior in observable, measurable terms so two observers would agree, with examples and non-examples.	Using labels like 'defiant,' 'angry,' or 'off-task' without describing actions.	A plan or data sheet describes the target behavior.
5	The FBA summary (hypothesis) statement	A hypothesis names the setting event or antecedent, the behavior, and the consequence that maintains it (its function), and it must be testable.	Writing a hypothesis about a student's character or diagnosis.	"When..., the student..., in order to..."
6	The Premack principle	Making access to a high-probability (preferred) activity depend on first doing a low-probability task increases the low-probability task.	Letting the preferred activity happen first as a warm-up.	A preferred activity and a disliked task in the same schedule.
7	Internalizing vs. externalizing behaviors	Externalizing behaviors are directed outward (aggression, defiance); internalizing are directed inward (withdrawal, anxiety, sadness) and are more often missed.	Assuming quiet students have no emotional or behavioral needs.	A quiet, withdrawn student in a behavior-screening question.
8	Check-in/check-out as Tier 2	CICO is a Tier 2 intervention: daily check-in with a mentor, a point card rated through the day, check-out, and home report, for students who need more than Tier 1 but not an individual plan.	Treating CICO as schoolwide Tier 1 or as an intensive Tier 3 plan.	A student with repeated minor problems despite good Tier 1 supports.

Course scope (public description): Behavioral Intervention Strategies and Applied Behavior Analysis prepares special education teachers to work effectively with students exhibiting challenging behaviors, with a focus on students with behavioral and emotional exceptionalities. This course provides an overview of behavior disorders

and their characteristics, as well as appropriate research-based intervention strategies, including positive behavior intervention and supports, multitiered systems of support (MTSS), applied behavior analysis, replacement behavior, and reinforcement strategies, culturally responsive practices, and data collection and assessment methods. After completing this course, learners emerge prepared to strategize and recommend adjustments to the learning environment that support positive behavior and student success in the classroom and beyond. This course also examines behavioral assessment and analysis, functional behavior assessment (FBA), and the creation and monitoring of behavioral improvement plans (BIP) that can be implemented in an authentic learning environment.